Beauty Black Friday Live - Post-Campaign Review

Results vs Targets

Metric	Target (see the campaign plan)	Actual	Verdict
GMV	$500K-$700K	$600.4K	On target
Conversion rate	6%-8%	8.62%	Above target
Peak concurrent viewers	5,000-7,000	6,488	On target
Operating cost	Planned $71.1K	Actual $73.6K	**3.5% over budget**; ad bids rose during Black Friday, the risk the plan flagged

ROI (the formula changed; here is why)

The first two versions were wrong. The first one subtracted only the operating cost, not the product cost, so ROI looked too high. The second one added the product cost to the denominator, which is also wrong: **product cost is already deducted in** `campaign_products.profit` (profit = sales - product cost; the customer pays for the goods, it is not money the company spent on this campaign). The real question is: **how much profit did the marketing spend (the operating cost) bring in?**

- Total product profit (sum of `profit` over the 3 featured products in `campaign_products`, product cost already deducted): **$168.8K**
- Actual operating cost (`campaigns.actual_operating_cost`): **$73.6K**
- **ROI = total product profit / operating cost = 168.8 / 73.6 ≈ 2.29**: every $1 of marketing spend brought back about $2.29 of product profit

Both numbers now come from structured fields (`SUM(campaign_products.profit)` and `campaigns.actual_operating_cost`), so the review no longer estimates them by hand or improvises a formula.

Product Breakdown

Product	Units sold	Sales	Profit	Margin	Return rate

Product	Units sold	Sales	Profit	Margin	Return rate
Sheet Mask	470	$131.6K	$45.4K	34.52%	10.2%
Lipstick	528	$127.6K	$59.2K	46.36%	19.2%
Serum	796	$110.1K	$64.2K	58.26%	19.7%

Findings:

1. **Serum had the highest margin (58.26%), the most units and the most profit.** The plan positioned it as the traffic driver; it turned out to be the most profitable product as well. A winter skincare staple does not need a deep discount to sell.
2. **Sheet masks had the highest sales but the lowest margin (34.52%).** The "20% off two boxes" bundle drove volume and gave away most of the margin.
3. **Lipstick and serum came back at almost twice the return rate of sheet masks (about 19% vs 10%).** For lipstick this is probably shade mismatch; worth checking the return reasons before the next campaign.
4. **Operating cost was 3.5% over budget**, the overrun the plan warned about ("ad placement bids usually rise during Black Friday"). It was small this time, but it points the same way as other seasonal campaigns.

Recommendations for Similar Campaigns

- Budget seasonal campaigns with a buffer based on the past overrun of actual over planned cost, instead of the ratio used for regular campaigns
- Keep serum as the hero product, and test a smaller bundle discount on sheet masks to win back margin
- Look into lipstick returns (shade guidance during the stream, swatch close-ups) before featuring it again